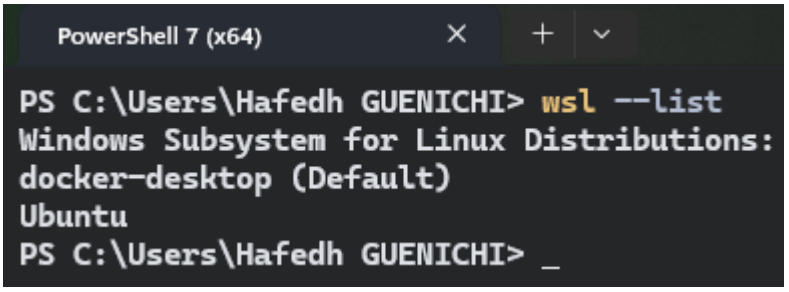
🧠 Overleaf Toolkit Quick-Start Guide

This guide assumes you're running **Ubuntu / Debian / Kali / Mint** in a Linux environment (can be WSL).

0️⃣ Install Ubuntu WSL (if not already installed)

```
# Open PowerShell
wsl --install -d Ubuntu

# Launch Ubuntu
wsl -d Ubuntu
```

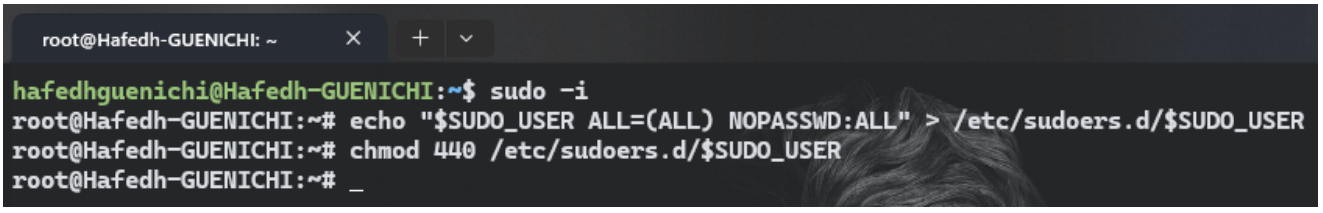


After installation, your WSL Ubuntu shell is ready to run **docker & Overleaf Toolkit**.

1️⃣ Prepare the System

```
# Optional: become root
sudo -i

# Add passwordless sudo for your user
echo "$SUDO_USER ALL=(ALL) NOPASSWD:ALL" >
/etc/sudoers.d/$SUDO_USER
chmod 440 /etc/sudoers.d/$SUDO_USER
exit
```



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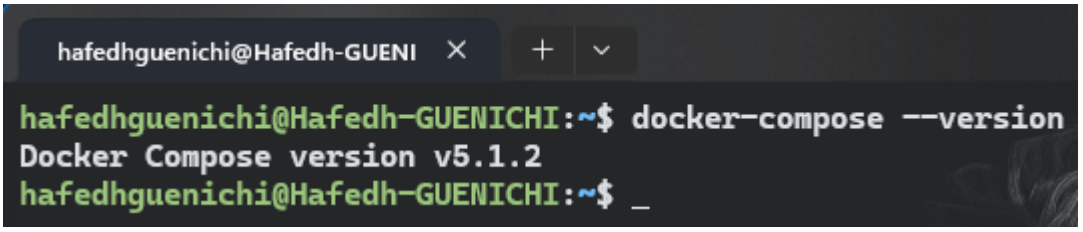
2 Install Docker, Docker Compose v5, and utilities

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install -y docker.io curl wget tree nodejs python3-pip
sudo systemctl start docker
sudo systemctl enable docker
sudo usermod -aG docker $USER
newgrp docker

# Remove old docker-compose v1 if exists
sudo apt remove docker-compose -y

# Install Docker Compose v5
sudo curl -L
"https://github.com/docker/compose/releases/latest/download/docker-
compose-linux-x86_64" -o /usr/local/bin/docker-compose
sudo chmod +x /usr/local/bin/docker-compose
docker-compose --version   # should show v5.x
```



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3 Clone the Overleaf Toolkit

```
mkdir -p ~/overleaf && cd ~/overleaf
git clone https://github.com/overleaf/toolkit.git ./overleaf-
toolkit
cd overleaf-toolkit
ls
# bin  CHANGELOG.md  config  data  doc  lib  LICENSE  README.md
```

---

4 Initialise Configuration

```
bin/init
```

Check `config/`:

```
ls config
# overleaf.rc  variables.env  version
```

Edit `config/overleaf.rc`:

```
nano config/overleaf.rc
# Disable sibling containers for CE:
SIBLING_CONTAINERS_ENABLED=false
```

> This is **mandatory for Community Edition**, otherwise CE will fail to start.

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5 Run the Doctor

```
bin/doctor
```

Should output something like:

```
====== Overleaf Doctor ======
- Host Information
    - Linux
- Dependencies
    - bash
    - docker
    - docker compose
- Configuration
- Warnings: ...
====== End ======
```

```
- config/variables.env
    - status: present
    - values
        - SHARELATEX_FILESTORE_BACKEND: fs
        - SHARELATEX_HISTORY_BACKEND: fs
        - OVERLEAF_FILESTORE_BACKEND: fs
        - OVERLEAF_HISTORY_BACKEND: fs
====== Warnings ======
! docker-compose v1 has reached its End Of Life in July 2023 (https://docs.docker.com/compose/migrate/). Support for doc
ker-compose v1 in the Overleaf Toolkit will be dropped with the release of Server Pro 5.2. We recommend upgrading to Doc
ker Compose v2 before then.
! Detected SIBLING_CONTAINERS_ENABLED=false. When not using Sibling containers, users have full read and write access to
 the 'sharelatex' container resources (filesystem, network, environment variables) when running LaTeX compiles. Only use
 this mode in environments where all users are trusted and no isolation of users is required.
====== End ======
hafedhguenichi@Hafedh-GUENICHI:~/overleaf/overleaf-toolkit$ _
```

6 Start Overleaf (Detached Mode)

```
bin/up -d
```

Pulls required docker images (Mongo, Redis, CE) and starts **all containers**

Logs can be followed if needed:

```
bin/logs
# or for multiple services:
bin/logs -f web filestore docstore clsi
```

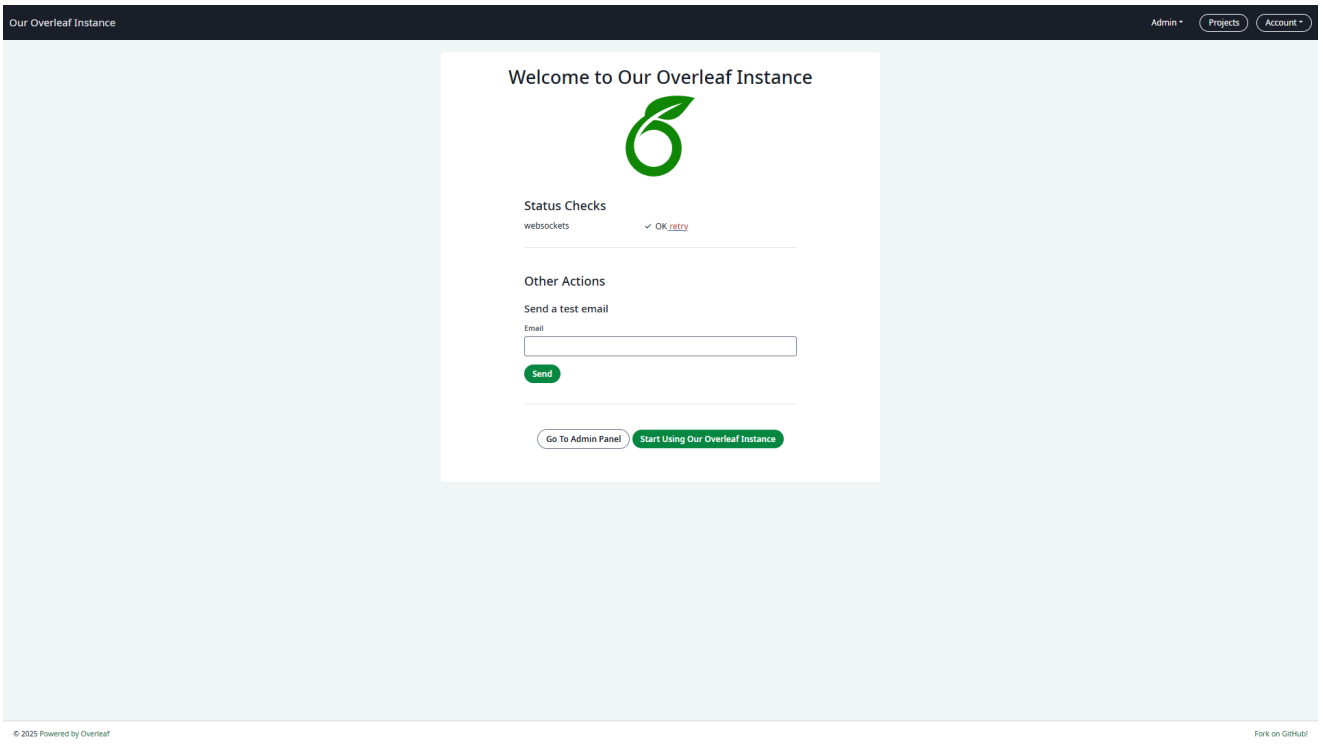
```
hafedhguenichi@Hafedh-GUENI
hafedhguenichi@Hafedh-GUENICHI:~/overleaf/overleaf-toolkit$ bin/up -d
Initiating Mongo replica set...
[+] up 1/1
 ✔Container mongo Running                                                                                    0.0s
WARNING: docker-compose v1 has reached its End Of Life in July 2023 (https://docs.docker.com/compose/migrate/). Support for docker-compose v1 in the Overleaf Toolkit will be dropped with the release of Server
Pro 5.2. We recommend upgrading to Docker Compose v2 before then.
[+] up 3/3
 ✔Container mongo      Healthy                                                                               0.5s
 ✔Container redis      Running                                                                               0.0s
 ✔Container sharelatex Running                                                                               0.0s
hafedhguenichi@Hafedh-GUENICHI:~/overleaf/overleaf-toolkit$ _
```

7 Access Launchpad & Create Admin Account

Go to http://localhost/launchpad

Fill in email & password to **create first admin account**

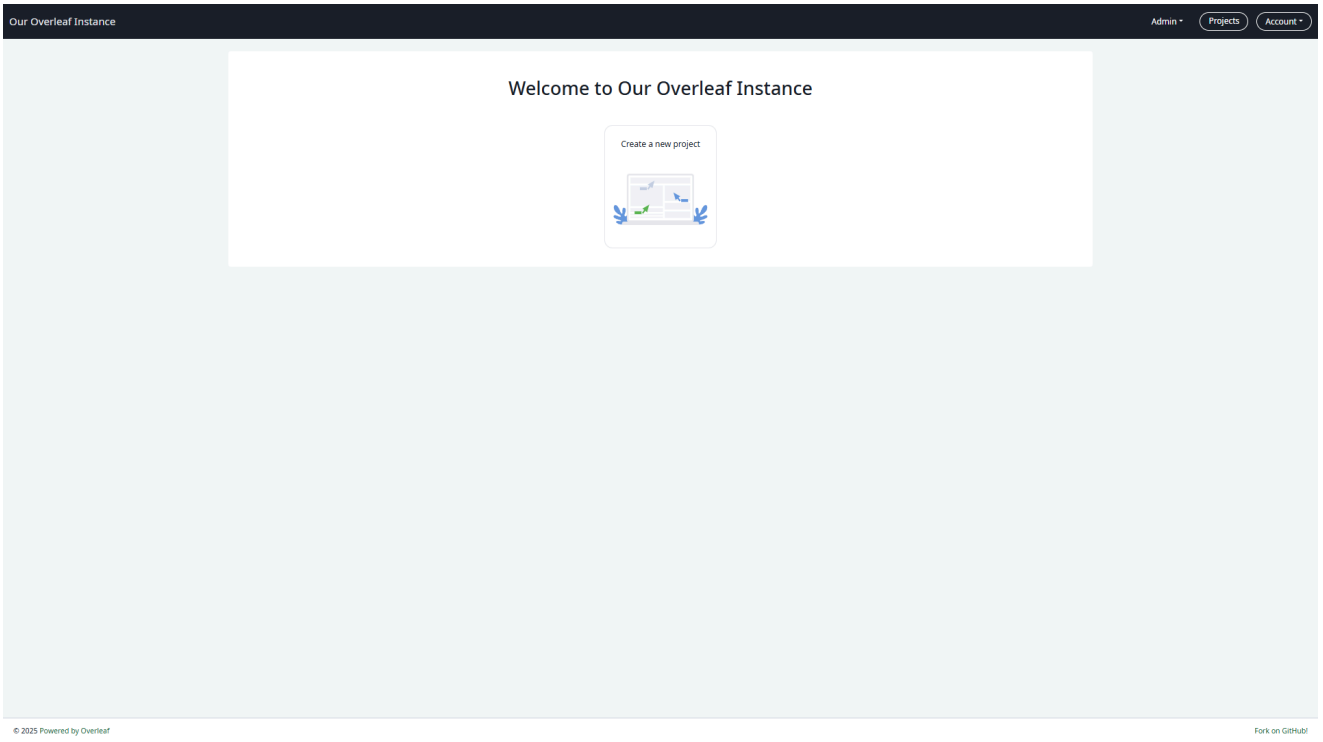
Ignore any test step, just log in and start using Overleaf



8 Create or Import Projects

Go to project page inside Overleaf

Either **import a project** or **create a blank project** for testing/editing



Optional: Install Full TeX Live inside container (~5GB+)

Inside the **sharelatex container**:

```
# Get the container ID
docker ps

# Enter the container
docker exec -it <container_id> bash
```

Update tlmgr to the latest release

```
cd /tmp
curl -LO https://mirror.ctan.org/systems/texlive/tlnet/update-tlmgr-latest.sh
chmod +x update-tlmgr-latest.sh

# Run the updater
./update-tlmgr-latest.sh -- --confirm

# Check version
tlmgr --version
# Example: tlmgr revision 78301 (2026-03-07)
```

Install full TeX Live

```
tlmgr install scheme-full
```

> Installs **all LaTeX packages**, XeLaTeX, LuaLaTeX, fonts, etc.
> Recommended for **Arabic or custom fonts**.
> This may take a while (~5–6GB).
> In the project **File** ~ **Settings** ~ **Compiler** ~ Choose **XeLatex**

Screenshot placeholder – TeX Live installation

```
[1740/4896, 09:36/25:58] install: gentium-otf [3k]
[1741/4896, 09:36/25:58] install: gentium-sil [15166k]
[1742/4896, 09:45/25:41] install: gentle [1k]
[1743/4896, 09:45/25:41] install: gentombow [11k]
[1744/4896, 09:45/25:41] install: geradwp [6k]
[1745/4896, 09:45/25:41] install: german [7k]
[1746/4896, 09:45/25:41] install: germbib [12k]
[1747/4896, 09:45/25:41] install: germkorr [3k]
[1748/4896, 09:46/25:44] install: geschichtsfrkl [6k]
[1749/4896, 09:46/25:44] install: getfiledate [3k]
[1750/4896, 09:46/25:44] install: getitems [2k]
[1751/4896, 09:46/25:44] install: getmap.x86_64-linux [1k]
[1752/4896, 09:47/25:46] install: getmap [8k]
[1753/4896, 09:47/25:46] install: getoptk [5k]
[1754/4896, 09:47/25:46] install: gfdl [13k]
[1755/4896, 09:47/25:46] install: gfnotation [15k]
[1756/4896, 09:47/25:46] install: gfsartemisia [959k]
```